

Curtain Call for TITANS



Political careers and reputations are at stake as the state heads for polls. This time around, many Maratha warriors are taking on rivals as well as fighting friends.

PTI PHOTO



| By Malini Bhupta |

The walls of Uddhav Thackeray's corner room on the fourth floor of Sena Bhavan are lined with all possible deities of the Hindu pantheon. His chamber, ironically, tells his story better than his critics do. While large gilded statues of Sai Baba and Ganesh adorn the desk, his father's towering portraits stare down from every wall. Perhaps the Shiv Sena's newly anointed CEO realises that he needs all the blessings he can get if he has to successfully fill the outsized shoes of his father Bal Thackeray and win the state. The forthcoming Assembly elections will seal not only his future but also that of the party.

Uddhav is not the only one for

MUNDE AND UDDHAV
UNVEIL THE COALITION'S
ELECTION MANIFESTO

GOPINATH MUNDE

The BJP's in-charge of the state, a lot is at stake for him

↑ After winning the LS polls from Beed, Munde has proved himself. He now has to capitalise on the anti-incumbency wave.

↓ By liberally handing out tickets to close relatives, he created a huge divide between himself and other BJP leaders.

UDDHAV THACKERAY

His efforts at giving the Sena a facelift have yielded little result

↑ Uddhav has been trying to expand the party's base to rural areas in view of the MNS's inroads in urban areas.

↓ His corporate approach has not cut much ice with the Sainiks. His battle with Raj will split the party's traditional votebank.